WHEN DISAPPOINTMENT THREATENS YOUR FAITH

What Elijah teaches us about despair, perspective, and the God who is still at work

> **A challenging truth:** Our greatest struggle may not be the disappointment itself, but the story we begin telling ourselves about God, others, and our future.

- **Disappointment is unavoidable; spiritual drift is not.** Pain can tempt us toward withdrawal, escape, destructive habits, or distance from God. Our response can deepen the wound.
- **Even great faith can collapse under unmet expectations.** After God's dramatic victory on Mount Carmel, Elijah expected change. Instead, he faced threats, exhaustion, and despair (1 Kings 18–19).
- **Our emotions are real, but our conclusions may be wrong.** Elijah believed he was utterly alone. His pain narrowed his vision until he could no longer see what God was doing.
- **God responds to weary people with compassion, not contempt.** Before correcting Elijah's perspective, God provided sleep, food, and water. Physical depletion and spiritual discouragement can be intertwined.
- **Disappointment can make our own story feel like the whole story.** Elijah saw failure and isolation; God saw a much larger plan already unfolding beyond Elijah's awareness.
- **God's silence is not God's absence.** The Lord works through both dramatic displays of power and quiet, easily overlooked moments. We do not have to see His activity for it to be real.
- **Hope begins when we lift our eyes beyond our circumstances.** The invitation is not to deny our pain, but to trust the character and purposes of God when our expectations are shattered.

THREE QUESTIONS FOR REFLECTION & DISCUSSION

1. Name one disappointment you are currently facing.
2. How are you responding to it—emotionally, relationally, and spiritually?
3. What story are you telling yourself about this disappointment, and how might God be inviting you to see His bigger story?

Scripture: 1 Kings 18–19 | Adapted from Curtis Heaton, "Dealing with Disappointment," Biblical Counseling Coalition, Nov. 11, 2026.